History Week 3 plus: medieval medicine (written)

Ember · Real AQA GCSE History question (Paper 2A) · about 20 minutes Date: _____

Skill: So What? After every Evidence sentence, ask “So what does this tell us about what these people valued, feared, wanted or believed?” and write one more sentence. Evidence must come from your notes or the reference page.

Reference page (for checking claims, not for copying)

- Physicians trained at universities run by the Christian Church. They studied the Ancient Greek writers Hippocrates and Galen.
- The theory of the **four humours**: blood, phlegm, yellow bile, black bile. Illness meant the humours were out of balance.
- Treatments included bleeding (bloodletting), purging, herbal remedies, prayer and pilgrimage.
- During the Black Death (1348–49) people also tried carrying sweet-smelling herbs against “bad air” (miasma), and some walked in processions whipping themselves (flagellants).
- These ideas were not seriously challenged until the Renaissance (1500s).

Plan (5 min): one row per treatment

Treatment (from my notes)	Why doctors used it	So what? What does it show?	Claim check: supported / check / source needed

AQA History 8145/2A/A, June 2023, Q02 [8 marks]

Explain the significance of the treatments used by medieval doctors.

Self-check (5 min)

□ Every Evidence sentence has a So What after it.

□ At least one So What says what the treatment **showed** about medieval society.

□ Every claim is in my notes or the reference page (I ticked the claim check column).

□ No modern labels for the past.

□ Reflection: which So What was easiest to write? Which claim was hardest to back up?

AQA mark scheme: June 2023, Q02 (8 marks), levels

- **Level 4 (7–8): complex explanation of aspects of significance.** Explains the relationship between aspects of significance, for example over time.
- **Level 3 (5–6): developed explanation of aspects of significance.** Developed reasoning considering two or more aspects of significance, supported by factual knowledge.
- **Level 2 (3–4): simple explanation of one aspect of significance.** Simple reasoning of one aspect, supported by factual knowledge.
- **Level 1 (1–2): basic explanation of aspect(s) of significance.** Explanation is likely to be implicit or by assertion.

Which level did you reach? _____ Underline every So What sentence in your answer. How many are there? _____

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